

Title

Clinical Outcomes of a Smartphone-Delivered Behavioral Flexibility Intervention for Anxiety Disorders

Abstract

A 10-week randomized controlled trial examined whether an evidence-based psychological app, delivered via smartphone and integrated into standard care, reduced anxiety severity in 96 adults (mean age 38 years) with generalized anxiety disorder. Half received the application alongside standard counseling and support; the other half received standard support alone. At 10 weeks, the application group demonstrated greater reduction in anxiety ratings (mean difference -2.1 points on the 21-point scale, $p = 0.003$) compared to controls. Secondary outcomes including worry measures and depressive symptoms showed improvements across all measures in the intervention group, with effect sizes ranging from small to moderate. Approximately 68% of users engaged with the prescribed frequency at the intervention midpoint, declining slightly to 62% by week 10. Improvements were largely sustained through the 15-week follow-up. Patient satisfaction with the digital tool was high, with 79% reporting it was helpful or very helpful. Results suggest smartphone-delivered psychological interventions can produce clinically meaningful anxiety reduction when integrated into routine care.